Lesson plan · for the teacher

How a chatbot writes

AI · Level 2 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk; A starter for each round, such as “In the rainy season, farmers…”, and one nobody can know, such as “Our school was opened in the year…”; The textbook page on the topic (to check facts)

Learning goals

- Build a sentence one likely word at a time, like a chatbot.
- Explain why a sentence can sound right and still be untrue.
- Check a fact against the textbook.

Activity: Human chatbot

1. Warm-up (5 min): Write “I will see you…” on the board and ask pupils what word comes next. Collect three ideas and ask which is most likely. Explain that a phone keyboard does the same: it suggests a likely next word.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that a chatbot writes the same way, one small piece at a time, choosing a likely next one from patterns in huge amounts of text. Stress that it does not check whether its sentence is true.
3. Human chatbot (15 min): Write a starter on the board, such as “In the rainy season, farmers…”. Six pupils stand in a line; each adds one likely word until the sentence ends. Play three rounds with different starters. Make one a starter nobody can know, such as “Our school was opened in the year…”: pupils still give a likely-sounding year, just as a chatbot invents a detail. In another round, let a pupil pick an unlikely word, and see how the sentence changes.
4. Check it (7 min): Read each finished sentence aloud. The class votes: true, false or not sure. For each one, ask how we could check: the textbook, the teacher, an elder. Check one together in the textbook.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Ask: how was our game like a chatbot? Agree that sounding right is not the same as being true. Then give the exit ticket.

Prepare three starters: two from this week’s topics, for example “In the rainy season, farmers…” and “The heart pumps…”, and one nobody can know, such as “Our school was opened in the year…”. Have the textbook page ready, so the class can check at least one sentence.

Discussion

- Why did some of our sentences sound right even when they weren’t true?
- When is it fun that a chatbot picks words with a little chance, and when is it a problem?
- How could we check a fact that a chatbot gives us?

Exit ticket

- Write one sentence that sounds right but is not true, and how you would check it.

Try it in class tomorrow

Play “Human chatbot”: Pupils build a sentence together, one word each, each choosing a likely next word. Read the finished sentence aloud and ask: does it sound right? Is it true? How would we check?

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Amina asks a chatbot for a rain story, then asks again in a new chat with exactly the same words. She gets a different story. Why?**

- ◯ It copied another story from the web
- ◯ Its training changed between her questions
- ◯ It picks likely tokens, with a little chance each time

2 **Which of these can make a chatbot's answer wrong, even when it sounds sure? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ It predicts likely words instead of looking facts up
- ☐ Its training text ends before recent events
- ☐ It invents a detail when it doesn't know
- ☐ It is lying to you on purpose
- ☐ You asked in a language it saw little text in

3 **The same message usually takes the same number of tokens in every language.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **Put in order: how a chatbot writes its reply.**

- ☐ Repeat until the reply is finished
- ☐ Add it to the reply
- ☐ Pick a likely token, with a little chance
- ☐ Score every possible next token
- ☐ Cut your message into tokens

5 **Match each surprise to its cause inside the chatbot.**

It doesn't know last month's exam results	• • • •	Invented details that fit the pattern
A reply in Hausa is slower and uses up a free limit sooner	• • • •	A little chance in each pick
The same request gives a new poem each time	• • • •	More tokens for the same message
It names a textbook that doesn't exist	• • • •	Its knowledge cut-off

Think of something your pupils might ask a chatbot. Where could a fluent answer mislead them, and how would you teach them to check?